

had conceded the Indian home minister's pleas for access to David Headley, the Pune attack could have been thwarted.

NALINI VIJAYARAGHAVAN,
Thiruvananthapuram

The heinous, cowardly and unabated act of terrorism in Pune has shocked the entire nation once again. Now it appears mandatory to redefine the meaning of the word 'terrorism'—it is almost similar to insanity. The war against terrorism cannot be fought complacently and left entirely to a bunch of intelligence officials and diffident police. Now every citizen, especially the ones living in metropolitan cities, must realise their responsibility to battle the menace.

INDU SHANKAR,
Varanasi

Pet Peeve

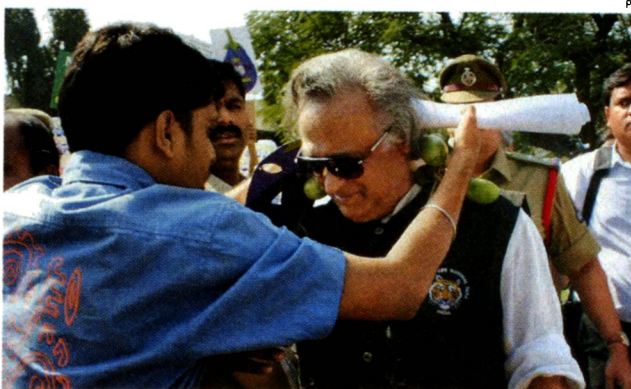
Your feature on man's best friend made intriguing reading ("Pet Indulgences", March 1). What stood out was the fact that the expenses involved—in a single week of the indulgences outlined in the article—were roughly equivalent to a contribution of a phase of immunisation to an orphanage. One must love his pets but the splurges documented in the write-up compel one to wonder as to where we are headed. Merely steps away from making

the world a better place for the deprived and the destitute, we choose to blog canine matrimonial sites in our spare time.

ARPITA SINGH,
Bhubaneswar

Futile Indulgence

While even a child can understand the futility of Indo-Pak talks, the UPA Government has decided



“The Union Government should investigate why some members of the Genetic Engineering Approval Committee approved Bt brinjal, overlooking protests by its other members.”

MADHU AGRAWAL, Delhi

to talk to Pakistan ("Why We Are Talking", February 22). All this despite the fact that Pakistan has neither closed down terrorist training camps on its soil nor has it punished any of the conspirators of various acts of terrorism on Indian soil. It clearly shows that the US pressure is working and the Pakistanis are having the last laugh. Buckling under US pressure would not

only make us a laughing stock, but also weaken our case in the eyes of the world community.

A.K. SHARMA,
Chandigarh

Shining India

It is heartening to know that the rural masses, which were earlier cut off from the urban ways of life, are now connected to

the modern way of life ("Rural Resurgence", February 15). Government initiatives and participation of many industrial houses in disbursing information to the villagers and providing opportunities for procurement of crop have led to the betterment of the farmers. Now, the well-connected farmers are in control of their destiny.

BHUSHAN CHANDER JINDAL,
Jalandhar

30
YEARS
AGO IN
INDIA
TODAY

MAY 1-15, 1980

A Jaguar Without Teeth?

Like the mythological, multi-headed Hydra, the Rs 1,500-crore Jaguar deal keeps growing an extra head as soon as one is chopped off. India's largest-ever defence purchase has attracted more verbal flak than any other comparable acquisition. Last fortnight, the Jaguar threatened to resurrect yet another flurry of controversy following murmurs of discontent from people actually involved in the operation of the aircraft. And, though the murmurs were characteristically muted, the implications were serious enough. Informed sources have made the alarming claim that 18 months after the original deal was signed, the aircraft supplied to India is totally non-operational for combat purposes. The sources have claimed that the aircraft's manufacturers, British Aerospace, are yet to supply the promised and much-publicised armaments for the Jaguar. The sources also insist that they have faced considerable teething problems with the aircraft.

by Dilip Bobb

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THE
JAGUARS

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